

The Noble Sūtra of the Great Glorious One

Ārya-Mahālakṣmī-nāma-sūtra · Toh 740 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་དཔལ་ཆེ་མའི་མདོ།

Toh 740 in the Kangyur is a sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Mahālakṣmī-nāma-sūtra and in Tibetan as the འཕགས་པ་དཔལ་ཆེ་མའི་མདོ། (Phakpa Palchenmo'i Do), rendered in English as the Noble Sūtra of the Great Glorious One. It is a relatively short canonical sūtra set in the buddha-field of Sukhāvatī, where the Buddha instructs the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara on the twelve names of Mahālakṣmī, the Great Glorious One, and the spiritual benefits that accrue to monks, nuns, laypeople, and all others who hold and recite them. The text belongs to the sūtra division of the Kangyur and reflects the broader tradition of dhāraṇī and name-recitation literature, in which the enumeration and contemplation of sacred names is presented as a powerful means of accumulating merit and protection.

Thus ends the preceding text.

In the language of India: Ārya-Mahālakṣmī-nāma-sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Sūtra of the Great Glorious One.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling in Sukhāvatī. Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One, looking upon the Great Glorious One, spoke thus to the noble Avalokiteśvara: "These twelve names of the Great Glorious One — whether a monk, or a nun, or a male lay practitioner, or a female lay practitioner, or anyone else at all — whoever knows them, whoever holds them, recites them, writes them down, or has them written: that person shall abandon poverty and become wealthy. Then all the assembled spirits, having heard this, beseeched together, saying, 'May it be so!'"

Then the Blessed One proclaimed the twelve names of the Great Glorious One, which are as follows: the Glorious One, the Auspicious One, Garlanded with Lotuses, Mistress of Wealth, the White One, the Greatly Renowned One, Lotus-Eyed, the Greatly Radiant One, the Active One, Bestower of Food,

Supreme Bestower of Jewels, the Great Glorious One.

Syād yathedaṃ. Jini. Ghr̥ṇi. Sarva-artha-sādhani. Śāśini. Alakṣmī-nāśaya. Siddhyantu me mantrapadāḥ svāhā. Abhṛkuṭī-parama-subhage svāhā.

This is to be recited three times. Whoever recites this at the three times of day — all circumstances adverse to that person shall be destroyed. They shall come to possess good fortune. Their prosperity shall become inexhaustible. When going to meet someone, if this is recited before the meeting, that person will regard them with the affection of a parent for a child, will be joyful, and will do whatever is asked. If it is recited constantly, without interruption, then even though Brahmā and the brahmins perform fierce and forceful rites against one, those rites shall not prevail, and one shall come to have served many buddhas.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, was overjoyed and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The Noble Sūtra of the Great Glorious One is complete.

Translated by the Indian paṇḍita Jinamitra and the great editor-translator, the monk Ye shes sde, revised and definitively established.

Translator's Notes

- The passage opens with a brief colophon fragment from a preceding text ("pa rdzogs so") before beginning this sūtra; this is a standard manuscript transition marker and is rendered neutrally.

The mantra passage is left in transliterated Sanskrit as dhāraṇī material conventionally remains untranslated. The reading "Alakṣmī-nāśaya" is notable: Alakṣmī is the inauspicious counterpart of Lakṣmī, so this phrase means "destroy the inauspicious one," a standard Lakṣmī-cult formula.

The line translated "Then all the assembled spirits beseeched together, saying, 'May it be so!'" is syntactically somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; it appears to narrate a response by the assembly of spirits to the preceding promise, which is inserted somewhat abruptly before the Blessed One's formal proclamation of the twelve names. The rendering follows the most natural doctrinal reading.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human

translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.